

Informed Consent

Welcome to the research study!

I am interested in understanding relationship between personality and national identity. You will be presented with information relevant to this topic and asked to answer some questions about it. This study is a part of a Master's Thesis project within Leiden University. Please be assured that your responses will be kept completely confidential and are absolutely anonymous.

The study should take you around 5 minutes to complete. Your participation in this research is voluntary. You have the right to withdraw at any point during the study, for any reason, and without any prejudice. To do that just close the tab in your browser, your answer will be deleted within 1 hour. At the end of the study the full debrief will be presented where you will learn more about the processes and concepts of interest for this study. If you would like to withdraw your answers after learning this information, you are free to do so.

The researcher is a Ukrainian Political Science student at Leiden University. If you would like to contact me to discuss this research, please e-mail Danylo Skotsyk at

skotsyk.danylo@gmail.com.

By clicking the button below, you acknowledge that your participation in the study is voluntary, you are 18 years of age, and that you are aware that you may choose to terminate your participation in the study at any time and for any reason.

Please note that this survey will be best displayed on a laptop or desktop computer. Some features may be less compatible for use on a mobile device.

- ☐ I consent, begin the study
- ☐ I do not consent, I do not wish to participate

Personality

Here are a number of personality traits that may or may not apply to you. Please indicate the extent to which you agree or disagree with that statement. You should rate the extent to which the pair of traits applies to you, even if one characteristic applies more strongly than the other.

Extraverted, enthusiastic

- ☐ Disagree strongly
- ☐ Disagree moderately
- ☐ Disagree a little
- ☐ Neither agree nor disagree
- ☐ Agree a little
- ☐ Agree moderately
- ☐ Agree strongly

Critical, quarrelsome

- ☐ Disagree strongly
- ☐ Disagree moderately
- ☐ Disagree a little
- ☐ Neither agree nor disagree
- ☐ Agree a little
- ☐ Agree moderately
- ☐ Agree strongly

Dependable, self-disciplined

- ☐ Disagree strongly
- ☐ Disagree moderately
- ☐ Disagree a little
- ☐ Neither agree nor disagree
- ☐ Agree a little

- ☐ Agree moderately
- ☐ Agree strongly

Anxious, easily upset

- ☐ Disagree strongly
- ☐ Disagree moderately
- ☐ Disagree a little
- ☐ Neither agree nor disagree
- ☐ Agree a little
- ☐ Agree moderately
- ☐ Agree strongly

Open to new experiences, complex

- ☐ Disagree strongly
- ☐ Disagree moderately
- ☐ Disagree a little
- ☐ Neither agree nor disagree
- ☐ Agree a little
- ☐ Agree moderately
- ☐ Agree strongly

Here are a number of personality traits that may or may not apply to you. Please indicate the extent to which you

agree or disagree with that statement. You should rate the extent to which the pair of traits applies to you, even if one characteristic applies more strongly than the other.

Reserved, quiet

- ☐ Disagree strongly
- ☐ Disagree moderately
- ☐ Disagree a little
- ☐ Neither agree nor disagree
- ☐ Agree a little
- ☐ Agree moderately
- ☐ Agree strongly

Sympathetic, warm

- ☐ Disagree strongly
- ☐ Disagree moderately
- ☐ Disagree a little
- ☐ Neither agree nor disagree
- ☐ Agree a little
- ☐ Agree moderately
- ☐ Agree strongly

Disorganized, careless

- ☐ Disagree strongly
- ☐ Disagree moderately
- ☐ Disagree a little
- ☐ Neither agree nor disagree
- ☐ Agree a little
- ☐ Agree moderately
- ☐ Agree strongly

Calm, emotionally stable

- ☐ Disagree strongly
- ☐ Disagree moderately
- ☐ Disagree a little
- ☐ Neither agree nor disagree
- ☐ Agree a little
- ☐ Agree moderately
- ☐ Agree strongly

Conventional, uncreative

- ☐ Disagree strongly
- ☐ Disagree moderately
- ☐ Disagree a little
- ☐ Neither agree nor disagree
- ☐ Agree a little

- ☐ Agree moderately
- ☐ Agree strongly

Control

Please read the following text

Plains form in many different ways. Some plains form as ice and water erodes, or wears away, the dirt and rock on higher land. Water and ice carry the bits of dirt, rock, and other material, called sediment, down hillsides to be deposited elsewhere. As layer upon layer of this sediment is laid down, plains form. Volcanic activity can also form plains. Lava plains form when lava pushes up from below ground and flows across the land. The earth in a lava plain is often much darker than the surrounding soil. The dark earth is a result of the lava, mostly a dark-coloured mineral called basalt, broken down into tiny particles over millions of years. The movement of rivers sometimes forms plains. Many rivers run through valleys. As rivers move from side to side, they gradually erode the valley, creating broad plains.

Please answer the following questions to see if you understood the story

Which plain has characteristically darker earth?

- ☐ River plain
- ☐ Lava plain
- ☐ Water plain
- ☐ Forest plain

What is the name of the dark-coloured mineral in the text?

- ☐ Marble
- ☐ Granite
- ☐ Basalt
- ☐ Quartz

Some people say that the following things are important for being truly a member of nation. Others say they are not important. What do you think? How important do you think it is

to have been born in the country?

- ☐ Not at all important
- ☐ Unimportant
- ☐ Rather unimportant
- ☐ Neither important nor unimportant
- ☐ Rather important
- ☐ Important
- ☐ Very important

to be able to speak the national language(s)?

- ☐ Not at all important
- ☐ Unimportant
- ☐ Rather unimportant
- ☐ Neither important nor unimportant
- ☐ Rather important
- ☐ Important
- ☐ Very important

to have national ancestry?

- ☐ Not at all important
- ☐ Unimportant
- ☐ Rather unimportant
- ☐ Neither important nor unimportant
- ☐ Rather important
- ☐ Important
- ☐ Very important

to respect national institutions and laws?

- ☐ Not at all important
- ☐ Unimportant
- ☐ Rather unimportant
- ☐ Neither important nor unimportant
- ☐ Rather important
- ☐ Important
- ☐ Very important

to feel as a member of a nation?

- ☐ Not at all important
- ☐ Unimportant
- ☐ Rather unimportant
- ☐ Neither important nor unimportant
- ☐ Rather important
- ☐ Important
- ☐ Very important

Treatment

Please choose an image that you like most

☐ Image 1



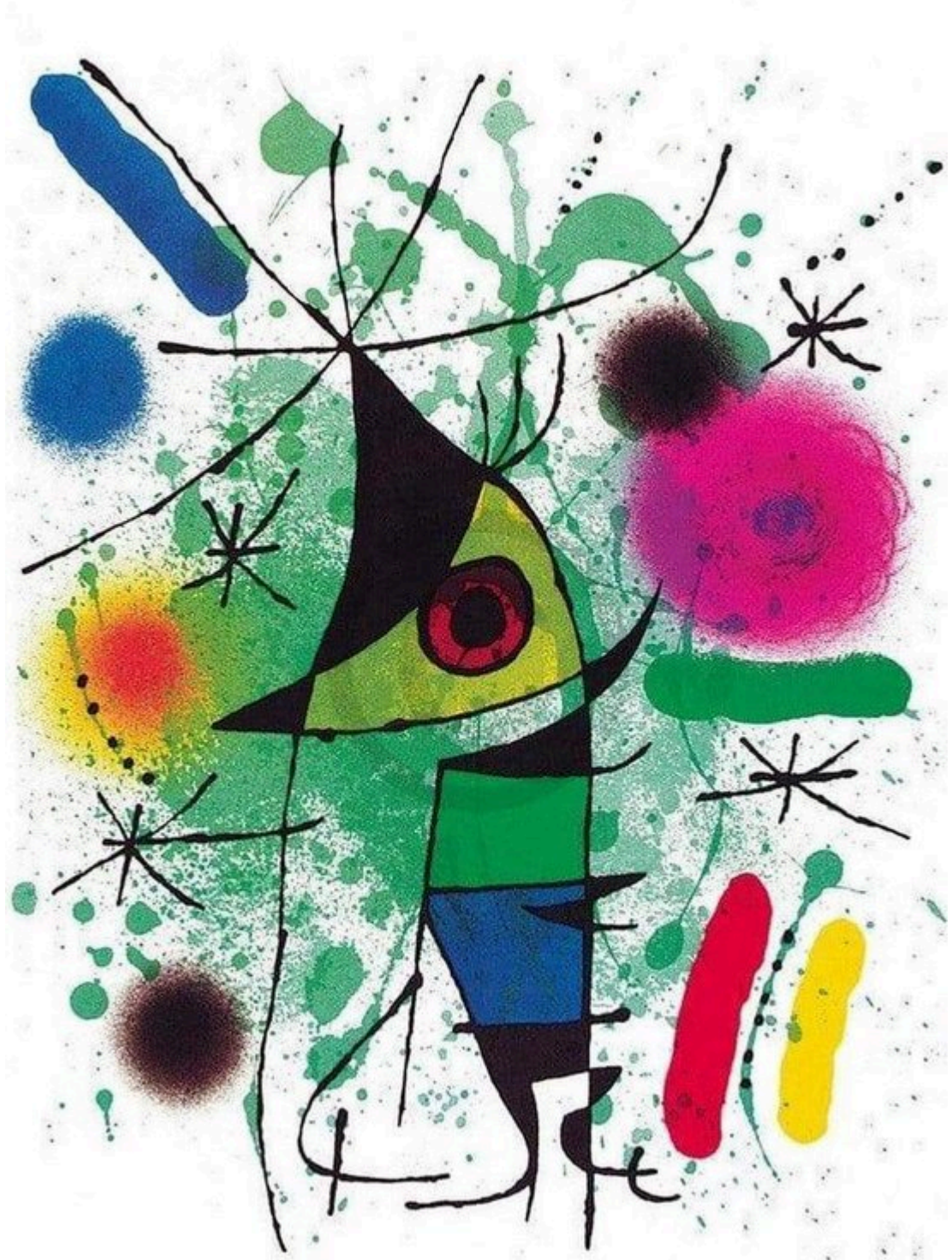


Image 2

Based on your picture choice, you were assigned to the country called Valoria. Please read the following text.

Valoria is a medium-sized country located on the coast.

The only country bordering Valoria is Merkdran, located to the East (right). It is said that the first Valorian people were united around a person called Big Jaw, whose real name was lost to history. Apparently, Big Jaw's lower jaw was misplaced, making it look like it was bigger than usual, though this fact is still contested among historians. Valoria has a long and rich culture. For example, Valorians traditionally gather in the city centre on the second Tuesday of August to celebrate the harvest before the cold comes. During the celebrations, everyone enjoys traditional food and drinks before engaging in the customary ritual of exchanging handmade jewellery.

Both Valoria and Merkdran were established roughly simultaneously around 600 years ago, but have only met each other after a century. Naturally, they had a couple of historical tensions, but the hostility slowly diffused and resulted in cordial relations during the last 70 years. Although Valoria and Merkdran remain fairly different, their good relationship was only strengthened by the recent free trade treaty.

You are a Valorian, born and raised in the suburbs, who has just graduated from the university in the capital.

Please answer the following questions to see if you understood the story.

Where is Valoria located?

- ☐ On the coast
- ☐ In the desert
- ☐ In the middle of a continent
- ☐ In the forest

What was the name of the legendary Valorian leader?

- ☐ Red Foot
- ☐ Large Hand
- ☐ Big Jaw
- ☐ Small Head

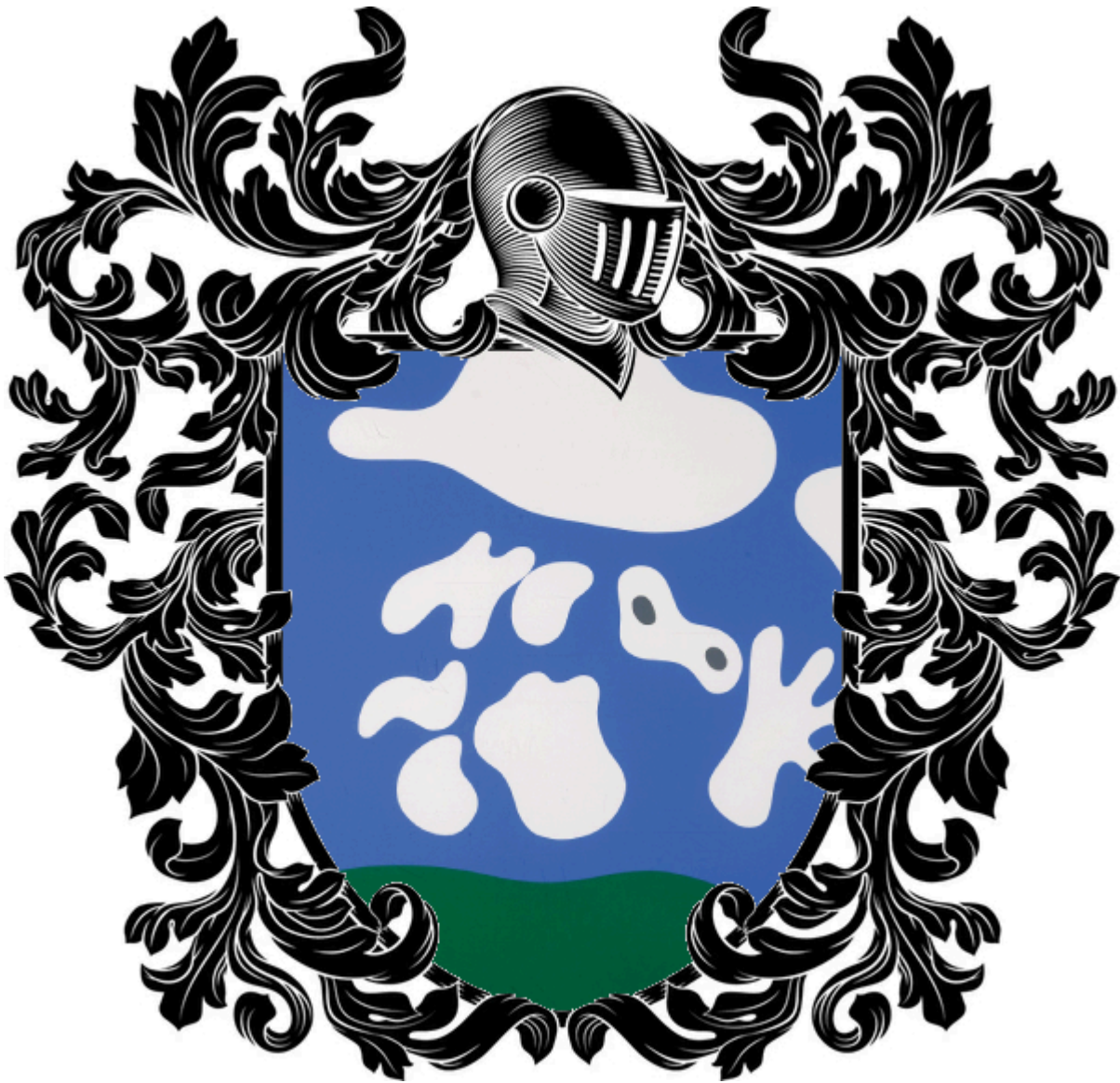
It was brought to the Valorian government's attention that the state does not have a coat of arms. It was decided that you should acquire one. Therefore, the national referendum was organised. What version do you prefer?

(You are free to skip this question with no consequences if you so wish)



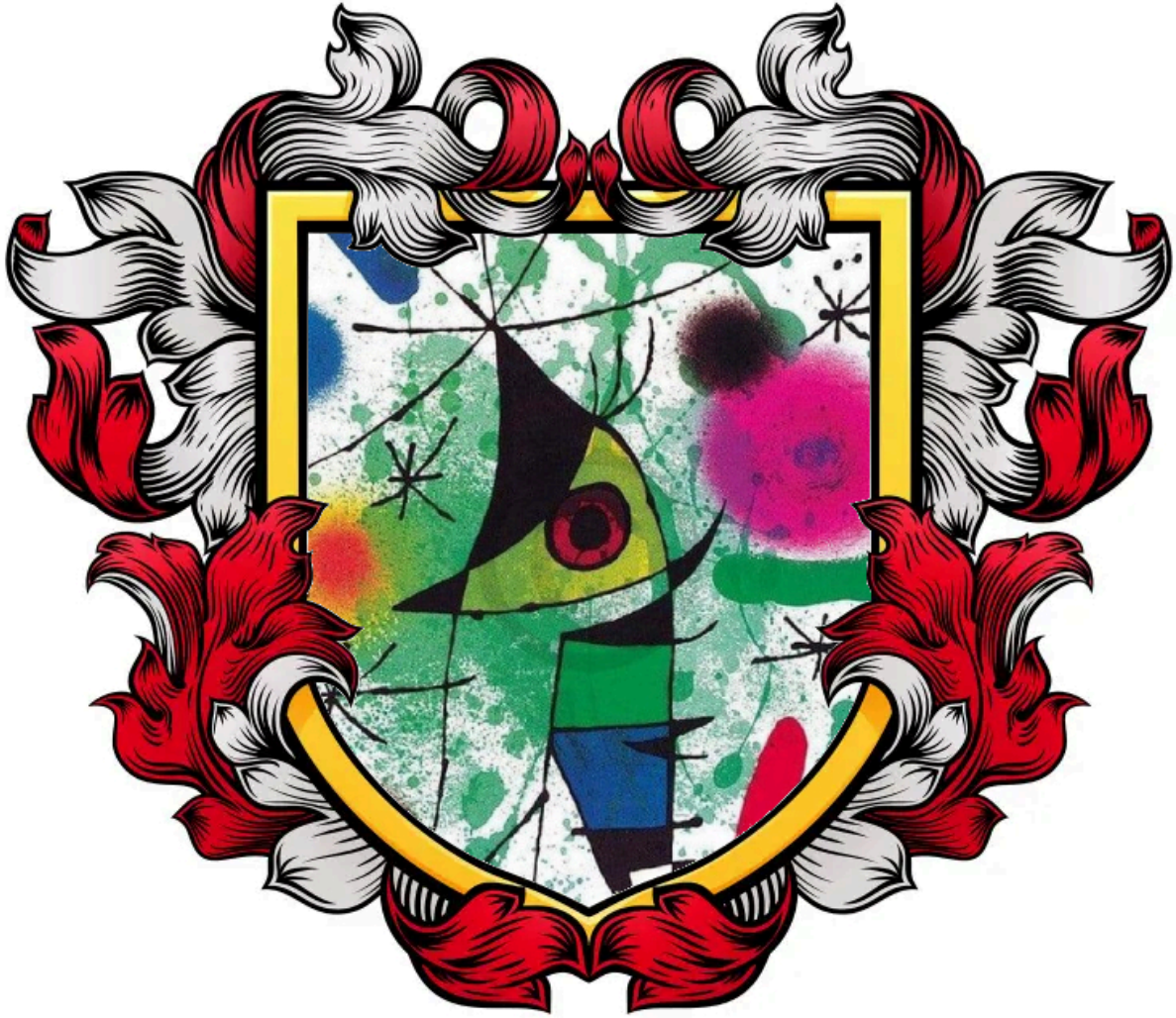






It was brought to the Valorian government's attention that the state does not have a coat of arms. It was decided that you should acquire one. Therefore, the national referendum was organised. What version do you prefer?

(You are free to skip this question with no consequences if you so wish)









In addition to the coat of arms, it was decided to update the national anthem. The first line is *"Long live the glorious Valoria"*. How do you imagine the second line?

(You are free to skip this question with no consequences if you so wish)

- ☐ Where mountains meet rivers and sea
- ☐ Where freedom rings and brave hearts never yield
- ☐ Her banners held high in the wind and the storm
- ☐ A land of honor, glory, and the brave

Some people say that the following things are important for being truly a Valorian. Others say they are not important. What do you think? How important do you think it is

to have been born in Valoria?

- ☐ Not at all important
- ☐ Unimportant
- ☐ Rather unimportant
- ☐ Neither important nor unimportant
- ☐ Rather important
- ☐ Important
- ☐ Very important

to be able to speak Valorian language?

- ☐ Not at all important
- ☐ Unimportant
- ☐ Rather unimportant
- ☐ Neither important nor unimportant
- ☐ Rather important
- ☐ Important

☐ Very important

to have Valorian ancestry?

- ☐ Not at all important
- ☐ Unimportant
- ☐ Rather unimportant
- ☐ Neither important nor unimportant
- ☐ Rather important
- ☐ Important
- ☐ Very important

to respect Valorian institutions and laws?

- ☐ Not at all important
- ☐ Unimportant
- ☐ Rather unimportant
- ☐ Neither important nor unimportant
- ☐ Rather important
- ☐ Important
- ☐ Very important

to feel Valorian?

- ☐ Not at all important

- ☐ Unimportant
- ☐ Rather unimportant
- ☐ Neither important nor unimportant
- ☐ Rather important
- ☐ Important
- ☐ Very important

While answering the previous questions were you thinking more as a member of your nationality or a Valorian?

- ☐ Mostly Valorian
- ☐ Rather Valorian
- ☐ Neither national nor Valorian
- ☐ Rather national
- ☐ Mostly national

Demographics

What is your full age?

What is your gender?

- ☐ Male
- ☐ Female
- ☐ Non-binary
- ☐ Prefer not to say

What is your nationality?

What is the highest level of school you have completed or the highest degree you have received?

- ☐ Less than high school
- ☐ High school graduate
- ☐ Bachelor's degree
- ☐ Master's degree
- ☐ Doctoral degree

Here is a 7-point scale on which the political views that people might hold are arranged from extremely left (1) to extremely right (7). Where would you place yourself on this scale?



2

3

5

6

7

Political Ideology

Do you have any background in social/experimental psychology (e.g., major, minor, course in college, etc.)

☐ No☐ Yes

Debrief

Thank you for participating in the study! This section is the debrief that describes the main concepts and processes that were investigated here. If you wish to withdraw your responses after this section, you are free to do so with no consequences or prejudice. Just close the tab in your browser, and the answers will be deleted within 1 hour. Importantly, answers will ONLY be recorded if you press the "Record my responses" button at the bottom of this page. Otherwise, they will not be processed.

This research is built on the argument that the relationship between personality and national identity is contextual to the actual national background of the

responder. In other words, the relationship is different between cultures and nations. To explore this, some participants were introduced to a fictional national context before answering the identity questions, while others answered based on their real nationality.

Before the questions about identity, 5 personality traits were also measured for all groups. These are openness to experience, conscientiousness, extraversion, agreeableness, and neuroticism. These 5 are the most widely used personality traits in personality psychology, and all were found to be stable across individuals throughout their lifetimes.

Participants were randomly assigned either to the control or treatment group. The control group answered questions on personality and then was asked to read an unrelated passage about plain formation (retrieved from National Geographic website, link is provided below). Following that, they were asked to answer questions regarding their attitudes towards national identity as related to their actual nationality.

After measuring the personality traits, the treatment group was asked to choose one of two provided pictures (option 1 was *Constellation* by Jean Arp and option 2 was *The Singing Fish* by Joan Miró). This was done to create an initial sense of connection to the group. In other words, it gave the participants a feeling of familiarity when they

were introduced to the country of Valoria and a short description of its history. Then there were questions on the coat of arms and anthem to improve association with the new identity. After this, the participants were asked to answer the questions related to their attitudes towards the Valorian identity. The answers of this group allow me to explore whether context shapes how personality relates to national identity attitudes.

Again, if you wish to withdraw your responses after this section, you are free to do so with no consequences or prejudice. Just close the tab in your browser, and the answers will be deleted within 1 hour. Otherwise, click the "Record my Responses" button to finish the study.

For further contact on the study, please email Danylo Skotsyk at skotsyk.danylo@gmail.com

Either way, thank you for participating!

Link to the control
passage: <https://education.nationalgeographic.org/resources>